

worth. The average buyer of a motor vehicle in America has a net worth that is less than 2 percent of that of these millionaires. Do they buy motor vehicles that cost 2 percent of what millionaires pay? If they did, they would spend, on average, about \$580 (2 percent of \$29,000). Instead, typical motor vehicle buyers spend the equivalent of at least 30 percent of their net worth for such purchases. Note also that, on average, American consumers buy new motor vehicles at a price that is 72 percent of the most that a typical millionaire ever spent on a motor vehicle. Does this give you some idea of why so few Americans are millionaires?

Those millionaires who lease vehicles are a minority—fewer than 20 percent. What was the “price” of their most recent acquisition/lease? We estimate that 50 percent leased vehicles that were priced at \$31,680 or less. About 80 percent leased vehicles valued at or under \$44,500. People often ask us, “Should I lease?” Our answer is always the same:

More than 80 percent of millionaires purchase their vehicles. If and when more than 50 percent begin leasing, we will change our recommendation.